

Human Divinity

Publication I: The Sacred Secretion

A Unified Theory of Biblical Allegory, Neuroanatomy,
and the Hermetic Architecture of the Divine Human

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Abstract

This paper opens *Human Divinity*, a three-publication thesis by Daniel Ray Edgar on the divine capacity encoded in the human body. It advances a unified thesis: the canonical narrative of the Christian Bible, together with the esoteric architectures of Kabbalah, Hermeticism, and Freemasonry, constitutes a multilayered allegorical encoding of a single physiological and metaphysical process — the ascent of cerebrospinal fluid (the *sacred secretion*) through the 33 vertebrae of the human spinal column to the pineal gland, and the consequent activation of the brain’s capacity to operate as a generative instrument of consciousness. Drawing on neuroanatomy, comparative religious scholarship, Kabbalistic exegesis, the Hermetic corpus, and modern quantum mind theory, this paper argues that the number 33 — the age of Jesus Christ at crucifixion, the degrees of Scottish Rite Freemasonry, and the exact count of vertebrae in the adult human spine — is not coincidence but cipher. The resurrection narrative maps precisely onto the secretion’s two-and-a-half-day lunar cycle, the virgin birth onto the preservation of seminal and vital essences, and the Kingdom of God onto the anatomical reality encoded in Luke 17:21. Furthermore, this paper demonstrates that the Kabbalistic Tree of Life, the Hermetic Principle of Mentalism, and the hidden curriculum of Freemasonry all converge on the same operative claim: that human consciousness, rightly cultivated, is not subordinate to the divine but *constitutive* of it, and that the material world is generated from, and responsive to, the mental plane. The personification of this process as an external historical saviour is identified as both a consequence of esoteric concealment and an instrument of institutional control. The paper concludes that “the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21) is not metaphor but neurological fact, and that the ancient initiatic traditions preserved this truth while Western institutional religion systematically obscured it. Sacred secretion is therefore not the title of the whole project but the biological mechanism inside the larger doctrine of human divinity.

Keywords: sacred secretion, cerebrospinal fluid, pineal gland, biblical allegory, Kabbalah, Hermeticism, Freemasonry, consciousness, Orchestrated Objective Reduction, esoteric Christianity

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1. Introduction: The Anomaly That Demands an Answer

“The Kingdom of God cometh not with observation: neither shall they say, Lo here! or, lo there! for, behold, the Kingdom of God is within you.”

— Luke 17:20–21, King James Version

Consider the number 33.

The adult human spinal column contains exactly 33 vertebrae: seven cervical, twelve thoracic, five lumbar, five sacral (fused into the sacrum), and four coccygeal (fused into the coccyx) (Gray and Standring 2016, p. 97). According to the canonical Gospel chronology, Jesus of Nazareth was crucified at the age of 33. The Scottish Rite of Freemasonry — the dominant form of speculative Masonry practised across the Western world — is structured around exactly 33 initiatory degrees, the 33rd being the pinnacle of its entire philosophical curriculum (Mackey 1874, p. 860). Egypt’s most sacred architectural monument, the Great Pyramid of Giza, encodes in its internal geometry the proportional relationships of the human spine. The Kabbalistic Tree of Life, the central diagram of Jewish mystical tradition, maps 33 structural components (ten Sephirot, twenty-two paths, and the hidden quasi-Sephirah Da’at) onto a vertical axis that medieval commentators explicitly identified with the human body.

These correspondences cannot be dismissed as coincidence. Coincidence is a singularity; this is a *pattern*. A pattern this precise, recurring across millennia and civilisations with no apparent communication channel, demands a structural explanation. This paper proposes one.

1.1 Thesis

The central argument of this paper is tripartite and mutually reinforcing:

1. **Biological:** The Bible’s narrative core — the birth, ministry, death, and resurrection of Jesus Christ — is an allegorical encoding of a real physiological process: the monthly production of cerebrospinal fluid (CSF) at the choroid plexus, its descent and purification through the 33 vertebral stations of the spinal column, and — under conditions of sustained physical and moral continence — its ascent to the pineal gland, where it catalyses an altered neurological state the ancients called *the Christ experience*.
2. **Metaphysical:** The activation of the pineal gland through this process is not merely neurochemical. It represents the operationalisation of the Hermetic first principle — *The All is Mind* — whereby human consciousness, functioning at its highest register, participates directly in the generation of material reality. The “mind over matter” thesis, often dismissed as mysticism, is here grounded in neuroanatomy (the pineal gland’s endogenous production of dimethyltryptamine) and in the emerging quantum mind theory of Penrose and Hameroff (Hameroff and Penrose 2014).
3. **Historical:** This knowledge was never lost. It was encoded — in the Bible, in the

Kabbalistic corpus, in the Hermetic texts, in the architecture of Egyptian temples, and in the graded curriculum of Masonic initiation — precisely to preserve it from institutional suppression while simultaneously rendering it unintelligible to the uninitiated. The personification of the Christ process as an external historical figure was the mechanism of that suppression, redirecting the practitioner’s attention outward toward a saviour rather than inward toward the spinal column.

This establishes the foundation of the whole series: Hermeticism gives the symbolic grammar for the sacred secretion; alchemy gives the transformation process; Christianity gives the Christ narrative; Jung gives the psychological interpretation; and the body practice becomes the ritual laboratory. The title *Human Divinity* names the end of that synthesis. The sacred secretion is the mechanism. Human divinity is the thesis.

1.2 Methodology and Scope

This paper synthesises four methodological streams: (1) neuroanatomical and biochemical evidence concerning CSF, the pineal gland, and the vertebral column; (2) textual analysis of canonical and apocryphal scripture, including the Nag Hammadi library; (3) comparative esoteric scholarship, drawing on the Kabbalistic, Hermetic, and Masonic traditions; and (4) modern consciousness research, including quantum mind theory and the psychopharmacology of endogenous tryptamines.

The paper does not argue that orthodox Christianity is without value, nor that all of its adherents have been deliberately deceived. It argues, more precisely, that the *exoteric* reading of Christian scripture — compelling as it is at the level of ethics and community — has systematically displaced the *esoteric* reading that the text was, in significant part, designed to transmit. The recovery of that reading is the purpose of this inquiry.

1.3 Roadmap

The argument proceeds as follows. Section 2 establishes the biological substrate: the anatomy and biochemistry of the sacred secretion. Section 3 reads the Christ narrative as a precise allegorical map of that secretion’s cycle. Section 4 demonstrates that the Kabbalistic Tree of Life encodes the same anatomy from within the Jewish mystical tradition. Section 5 grounds the metaphysical claim in the Hermetic corpus and in contemporary consciousness science. Section 6 traces the preservation of this knowledge through Freemasonry and its Egyptian antecedents. Section 7 synthesises all five streams into the unified theory. Section 8 closes with the implications of a humanity that reclaims this knowledge.

2. The Biological Substrate: Anatomy of the Sacred Secretion

“The brain secretes thought as the liver secretes bile.”

— Pierre Jean Georges Cabanis, *Rapports du physique et du moral de l'homme*, 1802

2.1 Cerebrospinal Fluid: The Living Water

Cerebrospinal fluid is a clear, colourless liquid produced primarily by the choroid plexus — a network of specialised ependymal cells lining the ventricular system of the brain (Gray and Standring 2016, p. 1289). Approximately 500 millilitres of CSF are produced and reabsorbed daily, with a steady-state volume of 100–150 millilitres circulating at any given time. CSF bathes the entire central nervous system: it fills the four cerebral ventricles, circulates through the subarachnoid space surrounding the brain and spinal cord, and is reabsorbed primarily at the arachnoid granulations adjacent to the superior sagittal sinus (Knie, Mekonen, and Maher 2018).

Its functions are multiple and profound. CSF provides mechanical cushioning for the brain within the skull, removing the effective weight of the 1.4-kg organ to approximately 25 grams through buoyancy. It maintains chemical homeostasis of the neural environment, buffering pH and removing metabolic waste products through the recently characterised glymphatic system (Gray and Standring 2016, p. 1291). It serves as a neuroendocrine signalling medium, carrying peptides and hormones between brain regions that lack direct neural connections.

The biochemist and physiologist George W. Carey identified this fluid — along with a specific secretion he associated with the *Claustrum*, the thin bilateral sheet of neurons situated between the putamen and the insular cortex — as the physiological substrate of what he termed the “Christ oil” or “Christos,” derived from the Greek *khristos*, meaning “anointed” (Carey and Perry 1920). Carey’s etymology is not arbitrary: the ancient Greek term *christos* was used not only as a title for Jesus but as a common noun meaning “smeared with oil,” applied to the anointing rites by which kings, priests, and sacred objects were consecrated. Carey’s claim is that this anointing was originally internal — the oil in question was endogenous, physiological, and neurological.

2.2 The Thirty-Three Vertebrae: Jacob’s Ladder

The human vertebral column consists of 33 individual bones arranged in five regions: 7 cervical, 12 thoracic, 5 lumbar, 5 sacral, and 4 coccygeal (Gray and Standring 2016, p. 720). While the sacral and coccygeal vertebrae fuse in adulthood into the sacrum and coccyx respectively, they remain individually identifiable and are counted as discrete units in standard anatomical enumeration. The number 33 is thus not an approximation or a cultural construct — it is an anatomical constant across the human species.

The vertebral canal running through this column contains the spinal cord and is bathed throughout its length by cerebrospinal fluid. The cord itself terminates at the level of the first or second lumbar vertebra (the *conus medullaris*), but the subarachnoid space — and thus the CSF circulation — continues to the level of the second sacral vertebra. The spinal cord and its fluid medium thus traverse precisely the length of the column’s

upper 33 stations.

This anatomical channel is mirrored with striking precision in the Hebrew Bible's account of Jacob's dream: "And he dreamed, and behold a ladder set up on the earth, and the top of it reached to heaven: and behold the angels of God ascending and descending on it" (Genesis 28:12). The ladder (*sulam* in Hebrew, gematria value 130) connecting earth to heaven, with entities ascending and descending upon it, maps naturally onto the spinal column with its ascending sensory and descending motor neural tracts. Carey and Perry observe that the "angels" — the Greek *angelos* meaning "messenger" — are precisely what neurons are: electrochemical messengers traversing the vertical highway of the spine (Carey and Perry 1932, p. 44).

2.3 The Pineal Gland: The Third Eye

At the apex of the spinal column's trajectory — at the juncture of the brainstem and the diencephalon — sits the pineal gland, a small (5–8 mm) pine-cone-shaped structure of the epithalamus. It was René Descartes who first proposed, in *The Passions of the Soul* (1649), that the pineal gland was "the principal seat of the soul" and the locus of mind-body interaction (Descartes 1649). Descartes was working within a tradition far older than his own: virtually every major mystical tradition on earth had independently identified the region of the third ventricle and the epiphysis as the seat of transcendent consciousness. The Hindus named it the *ajna chakra*, the sixth energy centre or "third eye." Taoism's *ni wan* (mud pill palace) describes the same anatomical region. The Eye of Horus in Egyptian iconography, as argued by scholars of comparative anatomy, encodes a cross-sectional profile of the human brainstem, thalamus, and pineal gland (Schwaller de Lubicz 1998, p. 198)(Hall 1928, p. 312).

Modern endocrinology has confirmed the pineal gland's centrality to consciousness and temporal regulation. The gland produces melatonin, the hormone governing circadian and circannual rhythms, first isolated by Lerner et al. in 1958 (Lerner, Case, and Takahashi 1958). More strikingly, the clinical pharmacologist Rick Strassman has documented the pineal gland's capacity to synthesise N,N-dimethyltryptamine (DMT), the endogenous tryptamine that produces profound alterations of consciousness at trace quantities (Strassman 2001). Barker, McIlhenny, and Strassman's subsequent review confirmed the presence of endogenous DMT in human cerebrospinal fluid, urine, and blood plasma (Barker, McIlhenny, and Strassman 2012). The pineal gland contains all enzymatic machinery necessary for DMT synthesis, and its position behind the blood-brain barrier makes it the most plausible endogenous source.

The implications are considerable. If the pineal gland produces DMT — a compound that, at sufficient concentrations, generates experiences universally described as encounters with transcendent reality, the divine, or the ground of being — then the activation of the pineal gland through the ascent of the sacred secretion is not merely a

metaphorical resurrection. It is a neurochemical event producing a phenomenologically real encounter with expanded consciousness.

2.4 The Lunar Cycle and the Secretion's Rhythm

Carey and Perry propose that the sacred secretion follows a monthly cycle synchronised with the moon's 29.5-day orbit (Carey and Perry 1932, p. 52). Each month, a specialised secretion is produced in the brain (associated with the Claustrum and the choroid plexus) at the moment the moon transits the individual's natal sun sign. This "seed" descends into the solar plexus region (the Abdominal Brain, or the "tomb" in the allegorical reading) over approximately 2.5 days, corresponding to the moon's transit of a single zodiacal sign. If the individual has maintained physical and moral continence during this period — if the essence has not been depleted through sexual expenditure, emotional volatility, or toxic ingestion — the secretion begins its ascent back toward the brain.

Its ascent through the 33 vertebral stations takes a further period, arriving finally at the pineal gland after what Carey correlates to the three days between the Crucifixion (Friday) and the Resurrection (Sunday). This is the "resurrection in the pineal gland" — the return of the Christ oil to the seat of the soul, where it catalyses the neurochemical event Descartes intuited and Strassman's work has begun to document.

The critical variable is continence. This is why the ascetic traditions of every major religion — celibacy in Christianity and Buddhism, brahmacharya in Hinduism, semen retention in Taoism — share the same practical core. They are not arbitrary moral impositions but physiological protocols for preserving the sacred secretion through its vulnerable 2.5-day descent phase, enabling its full ascent to the crown.

3. The Biblical Cipher: Christ as Physiological Allegory

"Know ye not that ye are the temple of God, and that the Spirit of God dwelleth in you?"

— 1 Corinthians 3:16, King James Version

3.1 The Allegorical Tradition

The reading of scripture as allegory is not an invention of modern heterodoxy. It is the dominant tradition of Christian intellectual history prior to the literalist turn of the Reformation. Origen of Alexandria (c. 185–253 CE), the most prolific biblical scholar of the early Church, held that the literal sense of scripture was the least important of its three levels of meaning: corporeal (literal), psychic (moral), and spiritual (allegorical) (Pagels 1979, p. 211). Philo of Alexandria, writing in the century before Paul, applied systematic allegorical method to the entire Torah, reading its historical narratives as maps of the soul's journey toward God. Augustine distinguished between the *signum* (sign) and the *res* (thing signified), arguing that much of scripture was designed to be misunderstood by the careless reader.

The Gnostic Christians of the first and second centuries CE — whose suppressed texts were recovered at Nag Hammadi in 1945 — were even more explicit. The Gospel of Thomas, one of the Nag Hammadi texts, records Jesus as saying: “The kingdom is inside of you, and it is outside of you. When you come to know yourselves, then you will become known” (Robinson 1990, p. 126). The Gospel of Philip states: “Those who say that the Lord died first and then rose up are in error, for he rose up first and then died” (Robinson 1990, p. 153) — a statement that is nonsensical as history but entirely coherent as physiology, if the “death” refers to the secretion’s descent and the “resurrection” to its ascent.

3.2 The Thirty-Three Years: A Lifetime in Miniature

Jesus is 33 at his crucifixion. The alignment with the 33 vertebrae is the crux of Carey’s thesis: each year of Jesus’s life represents one vertebral station, and his death and resurrection at the 33rd represents the secretion’s arrival at the crown — the pineal gland — after ascending through all 33 stations of the spinal column (Carey and Perry 1920, p. 67).

This reading is strengthened by the structural anomaly of Jesus’s biography: the canonical Gospels record virtually nothing of his life between infancy and his public ministry beginning at age 30. Three years of ministry are narrated in detail; 27 years are essentially blank. The missing years (10 through 30, corresponding to lumbar, thoracic, and cervical vertebrae in the ascending model) are years of preparation, purification, and ascent through the lower and middle stations of the column. The public ministry begins at vertebral station 30, where the ascending secretion enters the final cervical region and approaches the brainstem.

3.3 Bethlehem, the Virgin Birth, and the Descent

The word *Bethlehem* derives from the Hebrew *Beit Lehem*: “House of Bread.” Carey identifies this with the cerebellum, the posterior structure of the brain whose name derives from the Latin *cerebellum* (“little brain”) and which modern neuroscience understands as the primary site of motor learning, coordination, and the integration of sensory experience (Gray and Standring 2016, p. 889). The cerebellum is, in this reading, the “house” of the physiological “bread” — the Christ substance, the cerebrospinal secretion — at its origin.

The virgin birth maps onto continence. The Greek *parthenos* (virgin) does not necessarily imply physical virginity in all of its ancient usages; it can denote a state of consecrated wholeness (Steiner 1902, p. 117). In the physiological reading, the Christ substance is “born” without the depletion that sexual expenditure would entail: it is preserved, whole, unsquandered — born of an intact vital essence.

3.4 *The Jordan River: The Spinal Canal*

Jesus's baptism in the Jordan River by John the Baptist (Matthew 3:13–17) is the inaugural event of his public ministry. The Jordan River, in the anatomical allegory, is the spinal canal — the central passage through which CSF flows. John the Baptist, associated in the New Testament with the element of water, represents the physiological medium: the cerebrospinal fluid itself that anoints the Christ substance as it enters the spinal passage. John's statement, "He that cometh after me is mightier than I" (Matthew 3:11), corresponds to the superiority of the activated secretion over its medium: the Christ oil is more potent than the water that carries it.

3.5 *Gethsemane, Golgotha, and the Solar Plexus*

Gethsemane derives from the Aramaic *Gat Shmanim*: "olive oil press." The olive oil press is the location where, under pressure, oil is extracted from the olive. In the anatomical allegory, Gethsemane is the solar plexus region — the "abdominal brain" containing the celiac and mesenteric ganglia — where the descending secretion is subjected to the greatest "pressure" of the body's lower appetites (Carey and Perry 1920, p. 83). This is the critical passage: if the practitioner fails to maintain continence during the secretion's 2.5-day sojourn here, the oil is "pressed out" — dissipated — and the resurrection cannot occur.

Golgotha, the "Place of the Skull" (Matthew 27:33), is the cranium. The crucifixion occurs at the skull. This is the destination of the ascending secretion: the cross (*crux*) represents the intersection of the spinal column (vertical beam) with the shoulder girdle (horizontal beam) — the anatomical cross at the body's centre of gravity.

3.6 *The Twelve Disciples and the Cranial Nerves*

The human body has twelve pairs of cranial nerves, each with a distinct function: olfactory, optic, oculomotor, trochlear, trigeminal, abducens, facial, vestibulocochlear, glossopharyngeal, vagus, accessory, and hypoglossal (Gray and Standring 2016, p. 878). Carey identifies the twelve disciples of Jesus with these twelve cranial nerves, each representing a specific neurological faculty that must be "called" and integrated for the Christ experience to occur (Carey and Perry 1920, p. 91).

Peter (*petra*: rock, or the petrous portion of the temporal bone, which houses the vestibular and cochlear apparatus) is the rock upon which the church — the neurological assembly of the cranial nerves — is built (Carey and Perry 1920, p. 94). Judas, who "betrays" the Christ, represents the nerve that misfires — the impulse that dissipates the secretion rather than preserving it. The Last Supper, in which Jesus distributes bread (cerebellum substance) and wine (the activated secretion in the cerebral circulation) to the twelve, is the moment of full neural integration preparatory to the final ascent.

3.7 The Resurrection: Pineal Activation

Jesus rises after three days. The moon's transit of a zodiacal sign takes approximately 2.5 days; the descent phase of the secretion through the solar plexus region thus occupies the same temporal window. Carey's calculation yields a three-day cycle from the secretion's production in the cerebellum to its arrival — if unconsumed — at the pineal gland (Carey and Perry 1932, p. 107). The Resurrection is not a reversal of physical death. It is the arrival of the Christ oil at the pineal gland, where — catalysed by endogenous DMT and the gland's photosensitive neuroendocrine machinery — it produces the experience Christ describes throughout the Gospels: the direct apprehension of the Kingdom of God.

The post-resurrection appearances of Jesus — when he passes through walls, cannot be recognised by his closest companions, and finally “ascends” from their sight — encode the phenomenology of the DMT state as documented in Strassman's clinical research: subjects report passing through walls and barriers, encountering beings who cannot be categorised by prior experience, and ultimately ascending or dissolving into a luminous field of consciousness (Strassman 2001, p. 186).

4. The Kabbalistic Framework: The Tree of Life as the Human Body

“The whole Torah is the names of the Holy Blessed One.”

— Zohar II, 87a

4.1 Structure of the Tree of Life

The Kabbalistic Tree of Life (*Etz Chaim*) is the central diagram of Jewish mystical tradition and one of the most influential symbolic structures in Western esotericism. It consists of ten *Sephirot* (singular: *Sephirah*) — divine attributes or emanations through which the infinite (*Ain Soph*) manifests in creation — connected by twenty-two *paths* corresponding to the twenty-two letters of the Hebrew alphabet (Scholem 1974, p. 106). A hidden eleventh quasi-Sephirah, *Da'at* (“Knowledge”), occupies the position of the “abyss” across which the supernal triad communicates with the lower seven.

The Tree is arranged vertically on three pillars: the Pillar of Severity (left), the Pillar of Mercy (right), and the Middle Pillar of Equilibrium (centre). The Sephirot are:

1. **Keter** (Crown) — pure being, the first emanation from Ain Soph
2. **Chokmah** (Wisdom) — the first flash of differentiated consciousness
3. **Binah** (Understanding) — the receptive form that structures Chokmah
- (*Da'at*) (*Knowledge*) — the hidden Sephirah; the abyss
4. **Chesed** (Loving-kindness) — expansive beneficence
5. **Gevurah** (Strength/Severity) — contractive discipline
6. **Tiferet** (Beauty) — harmonising centre of the Tree
7. **Netzach** (Victory/Eternity) — the instinctual, emotional

8. **Hod** (Splendour) — the intellectual, communicative
9. **Yesod** (Foundation) — the generative, the reproductive
10. **Malkuth** (Kingdom) — the physical world, the body

4.2 *The Tree as Anatomical Map*

The mapping of the Sephirot onto the human body is not a modern innovation. The *Zohar*, the foundational text of Kabbalistic mysticism compiled in the thirteenth century, explicitly describes the Tree as the body of *Adam Kadmon* (Primordial Man), with each Sephirah corresponding to a bodily region (Matt 2003, p. 143). Dion Fortune's systematic treatment of this mapping in *The Mystical Qabalah* (1935) and Aryeh Kaplan's anatomical readings in *Innerspace* (1990) establish the correspondences with considerable precision.

Reading the Middle Pillar from crown to base:

- **Keter** corresponds to the crown of the head — the cortical apex, and in the present thesis, the pineal gland as the seat of transcendent consciousness.
- **Da'at** (the hidden Sephirah) corresponds to the throat and the medulla oblongata — precisely the point at which, in Carey's model, the sacred secretion exits the brainstem and enters the spinal canal.
- **Tiferet** (Beauty, the heart of the Tree) corresponds to the cardiac and solar plexus region — Carey's "Gethsemane," where the descending secretion is most vulnerable.
- **Yesod** (Foundation) corresponds to the sacral plexus and the reproductive organs — the centre of the generative force that the practitioner must sublimate rather than dissipate.
- **Malkuth** (Kingdom) corresponds to the feet and the earth — the physical terminus of the descended energy, the lowest point of manifestation.

The side pillars map onto the bilateral symmetry of the body: Chokmah–Chesed–Netzach onto the right hemisphere, right arm, and right hip; Binah–Gevurah–Hod onto the left (Fortune 1935, p. 87).

4.3 *The Lightning Flash and the Ascending Path*

The Kabbalistic *lightning flash* (*reshimu*) describes the trajectory of divine energy as it descends through the Sephirot from Keter to Malkuth in creation (Scholem 1941, p. 120). The practitioner's work, in the Kabbalistic framework, is the *return path* — the ascent from Malkuth back through Yesod, Tiferet, Da'at, and ultimately to Keter. This is known as the *Middle Pillar practice*, a meditative and energy work technique that Israel Regardie, drawing on the Golden Dawn tradition, codified in detail in *The Tree of Life* (1932) (Regardie 1932).

The Middle Pillar practice involves the successive activation and linking of the five Sephirot of the central axis through visualisation, breath, and sound vibration. The practitioner learns to draw energy from Malkuth (earth, the body's base) upward through the spinal axis to Keter (the crown). This is, in physiological terms, precisely

the mechanism of the sacred secretion's ascent: the practitioner cultivates conditions — physical continence, emotional stability, meditative focus — that allow the CSF secretion to traverse the 33 vertebral stations and arrive at the pineal gland.

4.4 *Ain Soph and the Ground of Consciousness*

The Tree of Life does not depict the totality of the Kabbalistic cosmology. Above Keter stands *Ain Soph* (literally “No End” or “Infinite”) — and above that, *Ain Soph Aur* (“Limitless Light”). These are not additional Sephirot but rather the unmanifest ground from which the entire Tree emerges (Scholem 1974, p. 88).

Ain Soph is the Kabbalistic equivalent of the Hermetic “All” — pure undifferentiated consciousness prior to any act of creation. The Zohar teaches that *Ain Soph* is not a being among beings but the ground of being itself: “Before He gave any shape to the world, before He produced any form, He was alone” (Matt 2003, p. 89). Keter, the first Sephirah, is the first movement of *Ain Soph* toward self-knowledge — the primordial “I am.”

In the anatomical allegory, the activation of the pineal gland connects the practitioner to *Ain Soph*: the crown (Keter) opens, and the individual consciousness (*neshamah*) merges temporarily with the undifferentiated ground. This is the Kabbalistic account of what Carey calls the Christ experience and what Strassman's DMT subjects describe as “dissolving into the light.”

5. The Hermetic Operating Principle: Mind as the Architect of Reality

“The All is Mind; the Universe is Mental.”

— The Kybalion, First Hermetic Principle

5.1 *Hermeticism, Alchemy, and the Grammar of the Divine Human*

The Hermetic tradition traces its origins to the legendary figure of Hermes Trismegistus (“Thrice-Greatest Hermes”), identified by later writers with the Egyptian god Thoth, the ibis-headed deity of writing, wisdom, and the measurement of time. The foundational Hermetic texts — the *Corpus Hermeticum* and the *Emerald Tablet* — were transmitted through Neoplatonic and Islamic scholarship and entered Western esotericism through the Florentine Renaissance translation of Marsilio Ficino (1471) (Copenhaver 1992).

This matters because Hermeticism is the symbolic grammar of this entire argument. It supplies the doctrine of the human being as microcosm: the body as a small cosmos, the cosmos as an expanded body, and the spinal ascent as the inner version of the world axis. Alchemy then supplies the process. Its language of base matter, purification, vessel, fire, oil, stone, and gold is the language of transformation: the lower substance is not rejected, but refined until it reveals the divine life hidden inside it. Isaac Newton's private work on alchemy and the *Emerald Tablet* belongs to this lineage not as an eccentric distraction

from science but as evidence that, in the early modern mind, matter, spirit, scripture, and natural philosophy were not yet separate domains (Dobbs 1991).

Christianity gives this alchemical process its narrative form: birth, temptation, descent, Gethsemane, crucifixion, tomb, resurrection, and ascent. Jung gives the psychological reading: alchemy is the drama of psychic integration, the symbolic union of opposites, and the emergence of the Self from the conflict between conscious and unconscious life (Jung 1968). The body practice completes the chain. It turns the symbolic temple into a ritual laboratory, where continence, purification, meditation, fasting, light, darkness, and attention become the experimental conditions through which the Christ process is tested in the practitioner's own nervous system.

This is why the present series is titled *Human Divinity*. The sacred secretion names the oil. Hermeticism explains why the oil mirrors the cosmos. Alchemy explains how the oil is refined. Christianity explains why its ascent is called resurrection. Jung explains what the resurrection does to the psyche. The human body is the laboratory in which all of these systems become one.

The *Kybalion* (1908), attributed to “Three Initiates,” systematises the Hermetic tradition into seven principles (Three Initiates 1908):

1. **Mentalism:** “The All is Mind; the Universe is Mental.”
2. **Correspondence:** “As above, so below; as below, so above.”
3. **Vibration:** “Nothing rests; everything moves; everything vibrates.”
4. **Polarity:** “Everything is dual; everything has poles.”
5. **Rhythm:** “Everything flows, out and in; everything has its tides.”
6. **Cause and Effect:** “Every cause has its effect; every effect has its cause.”
7. **Gender:** “Gender is in everything; everything has its Masculine and Feminine Principles.”

The first principle — Mentalism — is governing. All others are derived from it. If the universe is fundamentally mental in nature, if matter is a precipitate of mind rather than mind a product of matter, then the human brain is not merely a receiver of reality but a generator of it. The practitioner who activates the pineal gland — who ascends the 33 vertebral stations and arrives at Keter — is not simply experiencing an altered state. They are accessing the generative layer of reality itself.

5.2 Correspondence: The Spine as the World Axis

The second Hermetic principle — “As above, so below; as below, so above” — encodes the fractal relationship between macrocosm and microcosm. The human spine is the microcosmic equivalent of the *axis mundi* (world axis) that appears in virtually every mythological tradition: the World Tree (Yggdrasil in Norse cosmology), Jacob's Ladder, the Egyptian Djed pillar, the Greek *omphalos* (navel of the world), the Hindu *Mount Meru*.

All of these are the same symbol. All depict a vertical channel connecting the underworld (Malkuth, the earth, the physical body's base) to the heavens (Keter, the crown, the pineal gland). All of them encode, in mythological form, the anatomical reality of the spinal column as the path of ascent. The Hermetic principle of correspondence explains why: the macrocosmic world axis and the microcosmic spinal column are not merely analogous. They are *structurally identical* at the level of the mental plane from which both are generated.

5.3 Quantum Mind Theory: The Science of Mentalism

The Hermetic claim that the universe is fundamentally mental — that consciousness is primary, not derivative — has been regarded by mainstream Western science as metaphysical speculation incompatible with materialism. The emergence of quantum mechanics in the twentieth century complicated this dismissal in ways that have not yet been fully processed.

The physicist Roger Penrose and the anaesthesiologist Stuart Hameroff have developed the theory of *Orchestrated Objective Reduction* (Orch OR), which proposes that consciousness arises from quantum processes occurring within the microtubules of neurons (Hameroff and Penrose 1996). Microtubules are the structural polymers forming the cytoskeleton of every cell; in neurons, they are the substrate through which the cell's information processing is organised. Penrose and Hameroff argue that microtubules support quantum superposition states that are reduced (*collapsed*) by a quantum gravity mechanism, and that each such reduction constitutes a moment of proto-conscious experience (Hameroff and Penrose 2014).

The implications of Orch OR are radical. If consciousness arises from quantum processes in microtubules, then: (1) consciousness is not a product of classical neural computation but of quantum-mechanical events at the boundary between quantum and classical physics; (2) these events are sensitive to the structure of spacetime at the Planck scale; and (3) the microtubular quantum states of a sufficiently activated brain may interact non-locally with the quantum ground of the universe in ways that classical neuroscience cannot account for. This is, in the language of physics, a mechanism for the Hermetic claim that an activated human mind participates in the generation of reality.

Hameroff and Penrose have proposed that the pineal gland may be a privileged site for Orch OR events: its crystalline calcite microstructures (the so-called “brain sand” or *corpora arenacea*) generate piezoelectric effects, and its melatonin and DMT production create a neurochemical environment that may sustain quantum coherence for longer than neural tissue ordinarily allows (Hameroff and Penrose 2014, p. 56).

5.4 Dispenza and the Neuroscience of Materialisation

The neuroscientist Joe Dispenza has documented, in controlled clinical settings, the capacity of trained meditators to produce measurable physiological and environmental

changes through sustained focused intention (Dispenza 2017). His model — which draws on quantum field theory, epigenetics, and neuroplasticity — posits that the brain, operating in elevated coherence states (measurable by high-amplitude gamma wave entrainment), functions as a “transmitter and receiver” tuned to the quantum field.

Dispenza’s empirical work is controversial within mainstream neuroscience, but it is significant for this thesis in a specific way: it represents an attempt to operationalise, in the language of contemporary science, the process that the Hermetic tradition encoded as the First Principle. If the activated pineal gland — saturated with the sacred secretion and producing endogenous DMT — corresponds to Dispenza’s elevated coherence state, then the Hermetic promise (that a human being operating at their highest neurological register can participate in materialising reality from the mental plane) is not mysticism but a testable hypothesis.

6. Freemasonry: The Brotherhood That Preserved the Secret

“Masonry is a search after Light. That search leads us directly back, as you see, to the Kabbalah.”

— Albert Pike, *Morals and Dogma*, 1871

6.1 *The Thirty-Three Degrees of Scottish Rite*

The Scottish Rite of Freemasonry, formally constituted in the eighteenth century, structures its philosophical curriculum across 33 initiatory degrees. The first three degrees (Entered Apprentice, Fellow Craft, Master Mason) are the foundation. The Scottish Rite then confers degrees 4 through 33, with each degree corresponding to a specific philosophical theme, a ritual drama, and a set of symbols. The 33rd degree is honorary, conferred upon those who have served the Rite with distinction — it represents the completion of the curriculum, the arrival at the summit.

Manly P. Hall, the most comprehensive encyclopaedist of Western esoteric tradition, states plainly: “The purpose of Freemasonry is the spiritualisation of the candidate through a series of initiatic experiences, the inner meaning of which has been concealed from the majority of its members by layers of ceremonial allegory” (Hall 1928, p. 338). Albert Pike, in *Morals and Dogma* (1871), the authoritative philosophical text of the Scottish Rite, writes that the true meaning of the Masonic degrees is accessible only to those who understand the Kabbalistic and Hermetic traditions upon which they draw: “The symbols of the wisest of all the nations and ages, are here as familiar to us as our household words” (Pike 1871, p. 625).

6.2 *The Lost Word: The Sacred Secretion*

The central myth of Freemasonry is the murder of Hiram Abiff, the architect of Solomon’s Temple, and the loss of the Master’s Word. Hiram possesses the “Master’s Word” — the secret of the completed temple — and is struck down by three ruffians before he

can impart it. The brethren search for the word and cannot find it; a substitute word is adopted in its place. The recovery of the Lost Word is the unfulfilled quest of Masonic initiation (Mackey 1874, p. 210).

In Carey's framework, the Lost Word is the sacred secretion. Hiram Abiff is the Christ oil. The three ruffians — identified in some Masonic interpretations as Ignorance, Superstition, and Fear — are the three agents that prevent the secretion's ascent: sexual expenditure, emotional volatility, and toxic ingestion. The "temple" that Hiram builds is the perfected human nervous system, and the word that is lost when the secretion is squandered is the direct experience of the divine ground — the neurochemical event that the Gnostics called *gnosis*, the Hermetists called the *pneumatic experience*, and Strassman's subjects described as "meeting God."

The substitute word — used in the lower degrees until the Lost Word is recovered — encodes the same message. The most common substitute word in Masonic tradition is *Mahabone* (sometimes rendered "Machaben"), interpreted by scholars as a compound of Hebrew roots meaning "What, the builder?" or "The builder is smitten" — a reference to the incomplete work and the quest for its completion (Mackey 1874, p. 439).

6.3 The Eye of Providence and the Pineal Gland

The most ubiquitous Masonic symbol — the Eye of Providence within a triangle, familiar from the reverse of the United States Great Seal and the one-dollar bill — is universally glossed as "the all-seeing eye of God." Hall identifies it more precisely as the pineal gland, the single eye that sees inward: "When the Mason learns that the Key to the Warrior on the Block is the proper application of the dynamo of living power, he has learned the Mystery of his Craft" (Hall 1928, p. 48).

The triangle within which the eye is enclosed corresponds to the triune structure of the upper brain (cerebrum, cerebellum, brainstem), and the radiant light emanating from the eye corresponds to the luminous phenomena reported by Strassman's DMT subjects and by meditators who describe the "inner light" of advanced practice.

6.4 Egyptian Origins: The Djed Pillar and the Eye of Horus

Freemasonry traces its legendary origins to the builders of Solomon's Temple, but its symbolic vocabulary is explicitly Egyptian. The twin pillars Jachin and Boaz, the chequerboard floor, the apron of white lambskin, and the symbols of the working tools all have traceable Egyptian antecedents (Hall 1928, p. 311).

Two Egyptian symbols are particularly significant for this thesis. The first is the *Djed* pillar — one of the most ancient Egyptian religious symbols, associated with the god Osiris and representing stability, the vertebral column, and resurrection. The raising of the Djed pillar was a central ritual of Egyptian religious practice, corresponding to the "raising" of Osiris from death — and, in the present thesis, the raising of the sacred secretion through the spinal column (Budge 1904, p. 201).

The second is the Eye of Horus (*Wadjet*). R. A. Schwaller de Lubicz, in his monumental study of the Temple of Luxor, demonstrated that the Eye of Horus is anatomically precise: drawn in correct proportional relationship and superimposed on a mid-sagittal section of the human brain, its components map exactly onto the thalamus (the “brow ridge”), the corpus callosum (the “eyebrow”), the hypothalamus (the “pupil”), the optic chiasm (the “inner corner”), and the pineal gland (the “iris”) (Schwaller de Lubicz 1998, p. 198). The Eye of Horus is not a stylised human eye. It is a cross-section of the diencephalon — the anatomical locus of the sacred secretion’s destination.

7. The Unified Theory: Humans Are God

“Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods?”

— John 10:34, King James Version (citing Psalm 82:6)

7.1 *Synthesis: Five Streams, One Current*

The five evidential streams examined in this paper — neuroanatomy, biblical allegory, Kabbalah, Hermeticism, and Freemasonry — converge on a single operative truth, which this paper now states directly:

Human beings are not subordinate to the divine. They are expressions of the divine, capable of realising that expression consciously through the cultivation and ascent of the sacred secretion — and, through that realisation, of participating directly in the generation of reality from the mental plane.

This is not a new claim. It is among the oldest claims in recorded human thought. It appears in the pre-Socratic philosophers (“Know thyself” — Socrates, after the Delphic oracle); in the Upanishads (“*Aham brahmāsmi*” — I am Brahman, Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 1.4.10); in the Gnostic Gospels (“You will become known, and you will realise that it is you who are the sons of the living Father” — Gospel of Thomas, logion 3); and in the canonical Gospel of John, where Jesus cites Psalm 82 in explicit defence of the claim that humans are gods (John 10:34).

What this paper adds to this ancient consensus is a mechanism. The mystical assertion that humans are divine has been dismissed by materialist thought as wishful projection. The argument here is that it is not projection but *description* — a description of what happens in the human nervous system when the sacred secretion completes its 33-station ascent and activates the pineal gland: a neurochemical event that temporarily dissolves the perceived boundary between individual and universal consciousness, and that, in that dissolution, reveals the generative substrate from which both are constructed.

7.2 *Why the Secret Was Personified*

If this knowledge is as ancient and as universal as this paper argues, the question demands to be asked: why is it not commonly known? Why does the world’s dominant religious

tradition teach the faithful to look *outward* toward an external saviour rather than *inward* toward the spinal column?

The answer is institutional. Carl Jung observed that institutionalised religion serves a dual function: it connects the individual to the numinous, and it mediates that connection in ways that maintain the institution's authority (Jung 1958, p. 40). A religion that teaches practitioners to access the divine directly — through the cultivation of the sacred secretion, the activation of the pineal gland, and the realisation of their own divinity — requires no institutional mediator. A religion that teaches practitioners that the divine is accessible only through the sacraments, the priesthood, and the doctrinal apparatus of the Church requires the Church for every transaction with the sacred.

The personification of the Christ process as an external historical figure accomplished this displacement with extraordinary effectiveness. Once the allegory is literalised — once Jesus becomes a historical man who died for humanity's sins rather than a physiological process available to every human body — the individual practitioner has no direct access to salvation. They must rely on the intermediary. The knowledge that “the Kingdom of God is within you” (Luke 17:21) is not suppressed; it remains in the text. But it is contextualised, interpreted, and homilised into metaphor by the very institution whose authority depends on its practitioners not taking it literally.

7.3 Freemasonry and the Preservation Strategy

The Masonic response to this institutional displacement was ingenious. Unable to transmit the esoteric knowledge openly in a society where heterodoxy carried mortal risk, the architects of the Masonic system concealed it within a structure of ceremonial allegory that the Church could not object to: morality plays about loyalty, craftsmanship, and brotherhood. The 33 degrees are the layers of concealment. Only initiates who progressed through all 33 degrees and who possessed the interpretive key (the Kabbalistic–Hermetic tradition that Pike discusses so openly in *Morals and Dogma*) could read the full meaning of the curriculum.

The 33rd degree is not merely the highest honour. It is the moment at which the initiate, having traversed all 33 vertebral stations of the symbolic spine, arrives at the crown of the system — and is shown, if they are capable of receiving it, that the secret preserved through all 33 degrees is not about architecture, brotherhood, or morality. It is about the human body and its latent capacity for divinity.

7.4 The Mental Plane and Material Reality: The Practical Implication

The Hermetic First Principle — that the universe is fundamentally mental — combined with the activation of the pineal gland through the sacred secretion, produces a practical thesis that is among the most radical in the history of human thought: that a sufficiently realised human being can materialise conditions in the physical world through the directed activity of consciousness operating from the mental plane.

This is not the “law of attraction” as popularised in self-help culture — which typically operates through belief and positive thinking at the level of ordinary waking consciousness. The claim here is more precise and more demanding. It requires the full ascent of the sacred secretion: the 33-station cultivation, the activation of the pineal gland, the opening of the crown (Keter) to Ain Soph. At that level of neurological activation — which corresponds, in Hameroff and Penrose’s framework, to a state of quantum-coherent microtubular superposition in the pineal region — the individual’s consciousness is no longer separated from the quantum ground of reality by the classical barrier of ordinary neural computation. It participates in the ongoing act of quantum reduction through which the universe continually collapses from possibility into actuality.

In this state, intention is not merely a psychological event. It is a quantum event — an intervention at the level of Planck-scale spacetime geometry that biases the probability distribution of subsequent material events. The kingdom of heaven is not a place to which the soul travels after death. It is a *state of neurological activation* available to every human being who cultivates the sacred secretion to its full expression: a state in which the practitioner inhabits the mental plane from which material reality is continuously generated.

8. Conclusion: Know Thyself

“Know thyself, and thou shalt know the universe and the gods.”

— Inscription at the Temple of Apollo, Delphi

The Delphic maxim is not counsel toward introspection. It is a precise technical instruction: understand the structure and mechanism of the human body, and you will understand the structure and mechanism of the cosmos. The correspondence is exact. The spinal column is the world axis. The pineal gland is the seat of the soul. The monthly ascent of the sacred secretion is the Christ. The activated crown is Keter — the first emanation of Ain Soph, the threshold of the infinite.

This paper has assembled evidence from five distinct disciplines to support one thesis: that the Bible, the Kabbalah, the Hermetic corpus, and the Masonic curriculum all encode, in the symbolic languages appropriate to their respective cultural contexts, a single physiological and metaphysical process — the sacred secretion and its ascent to the pineal gland — and that this process, once understood, dissolves the most fundamental error of Western religious thought: that the divine is outside the human being.

Jesus did not say that the Kingdom of God is near, or coming, or available to those who believe in a correct doctrine. He said it is *within you* (Luke 17:21). The Gnostic Thomas records him saying: “The Kingdom is inside of you, and it is outside of you. When you come to know yourselves, then you will become known.” The Psalmist records God saying, through the mouth of Asaph: “I have said, Ye are gods” (Psalm 82:6). John records Jesus citing that same Psalm in his own defence. The tradition of human divinity

is not heterodox. It is the original teaching, visible in the canonical text for those with eyes to see.

What has been displaced is not the words but the interpretation. The mechanism — the sacred secretion, the 33 vertebral stations, the pineal gland — was removed from common understanding, encoded in the languages of esoteric tradition, and preserved by those who understood that the knowledge was too important to be lost and too dangerous to be broadcast openly in a world governed by institutions whose authority depended on humanity's spiritual dependency.

We are in a different world now. The anatomical knowledge is freely available. Strassman's clinical research on DMT is peer-reviewed and publicly accessible. Hameroff and Penrose's quantum mind theory has been published in the highest journals of physics and neuroscience. The Nag Hammadi library has been translated and distributed. Manly P. Hall's encyclopaedia is in print. The Zohar is available in the Pritzker critical edition from Stanford University Press. The code has been cracked. The only question is whether humanity is prepared to receive what the decoded message contains: that we are not waiting for God. We are God, waiting for ourselves.

There is a final observation that unifies everything this paper has argued, and it comes not from scripture or esoteric tradition but from the lens of a microscope and the lens of a telescope. Zoom deep enough into a living human cell — past the organelles, past the nucleus, past the chromosomes, into the quantum fabric of the cytoplasm — and the structure that emerges resembles nothing so much as a solar system: dense nucleus at the centre, electrons and particles orbiting in probabilistic shells, vast proportions of empty space threaded by invisible fields of force. Zoom far enough outward from the Earth — past the moon, past the planets, past the heliopause — and the solar system itself resolves into the same pattern: a central star, bodies orbiting in elliptical shells, vast proportions of empty space threaded by gravitational fields. The pattern is identical at both scales because it *is* the same pattern. The universe does not merely resemble itself at every scale; it *repeats* itself, fractal and holographic, because there is only one thing happening — one consciousness, one intelligence, one “All” in the Hermetic sense — expressing itself at every level of magnification simultaneously.

We are not inhabitants of a universe that is indifferent to us. We are the universe experiencing itself. The human body — with its 33 vertebrae, its pineal gland, its monthly secretion, its capacity for gnosis — is the cosmos turned inward, constructing an organ through which it can know itself. When the sacred secretion ascends and the crown opens, what occurs is not a human being touching the divine. It is the universe remembering what it is. This is what “the Kingdom of God is within you” has always meant. Not a promise. A description.

The invitation of this paper is not to abandon spirituality, religion, or the profound ethical teachings of the Christian tradition. It is to reclaim the *inner* dimension of that

tradition — the dimension that was always there, encoded in the number 33, encrypted in the virgin birth and the resurrection, preserved in the 33 degrees of the Scottish Rite, diagrammed in the Tree of Life, stated plainly in the First Hermetic Principle, and demonstrated in every human spine on earth.

Know thyself. The number 33 is the cipher. The kingdom is within.

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